Universität Bremen

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Institut für Public Health und Pflegeforschung

Fachbereich 11
Human- und Gesundheitswissenschaften

The “grey” digital divide in older adults during COVID-19 in Germany: Who is most at risk?

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Introduction

The use of the internet among older adults has been shown to be a protective factor against poor mental health[1].

The “grey” digital divide might not only be a consequence of age but also of other socio-demographic characteristics.

Methods

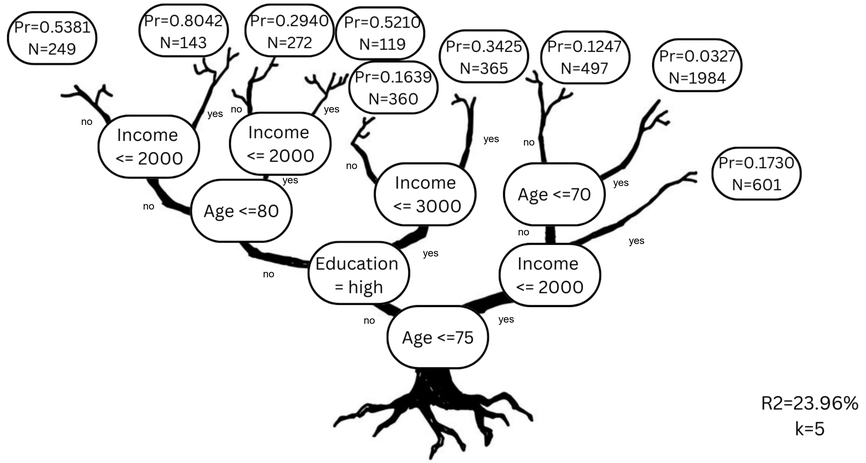
Database

- 2020 German Ageing Survey (DEAS)[4]
- Community-dwelling adults above 45 years old (N = 4,823; 56.5% response rate)
- Interviewed between June and July 2020.

Analyses

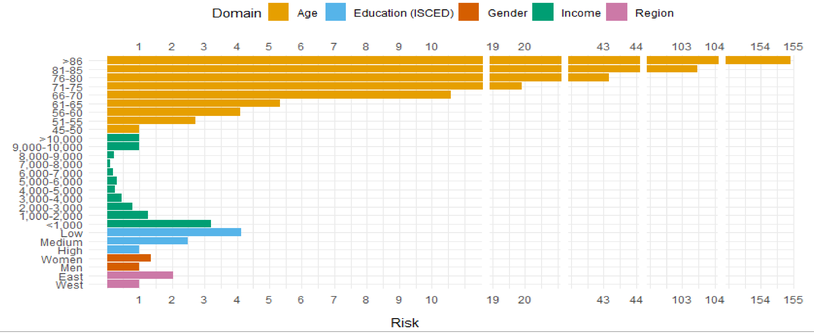
- Logistic regression (LR) provides information about the main effects of the predictors.
- Classification and Regression Tree (CART) exploratory, non-parametric procedure, illustrates the mathematical relationship of the predictors.

Results



R2=23.96%
k=5

Results



Conclusion

Being over or under 75 years old is the strongest discriminating factor for internet access in Germany during the COVID-19 pandemic.

There is a digital grey divide in the population over 75 years old, however, beyond this threshold there is an income and education digital divide.

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References

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